



# Equality Impact and Needs Analysis – Social Purpose of Land Framework

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## Guidance notes

### Things to remember:

Under the Public Sector Equality Duty (PSED) public authorities are required to have due regard to the aims of the general equality duty when making decisions and when setting policies. Understanding the affect of the council's policies and practices on people with different protected characteristics is an important part of complying with the general equality duty. Under the PSED the council must ensure that:

- Decision-makers are aware of the general equality duty's requirements.
- The general equality duty is complied with before and at the time a particular policy is under consideration and when a decision is taken.
- They consciously consider the need to do the things set out in the aims of the general equality duty as an integral part of the decision-making process.
- They have sufficient information to understand the effects of the policy, or the way a function is carried out, on the aims set out in the general equality duty.
- They review policies or decisions, for example, if the make-up of service users changes, as the general equality duty is a continuing duty.
- They take responsibility for complying with the general equality duty in relation to all their relevant functions. Responsibility cannot be delegated to external organisations that are carrying out public functions on their behalf.
- They consciously consider the need to do the things set out in the aims of the general equality duty not only when a policy is developed and decided upon, but when it is being implemented.

Best practice guidance from the Equality and Human Rights Commission recommends that public bodies:

- Consider all the [protected characteristics](#) and all aims of the general equality duty (apart from in relation to marriage and civil partnership, where only the discrimination aim applies).
- Use equality analysis to inform policy as it develops to avoid unnecessary additional activity.
- Focus on the understanding the effects of a policy on equality and any actions needed as a result, not the production of a document.
- Consider how the time and effort involved should relate to the importance of the policy to equality.
- Think about steps to advance equality and good relations as well as eliminate discrimination.
- Use good evidence. Where it isn't available, take steps to gather it (where practical and proportionate).
- Use insights from engagement with employees, service users and others can help provide evidence for equality analysis.

Equality analysis should be referenced in community impact statements in Council reports.

Community impact statements are a corporate requirement in all reports to the following meetings: the cabinet, individual decision makers, scrutiny, regulatory committees and community councils. Community impact statements enable decision makers to identify more easily how a decision might affect different communities in Southwark and to consider any implications for equality and diversity.

The public will be able to view and scrutinise any equality analysis undertaken. Equality analysis should therefore be written in a clear and transparent way using plain English. Equality analysis may be published under the council's publishing of equality information, or be present with divisional/departmental/service business plans. These will be placed on the website for public view under the council's Publications Scheme. All Cabinet reports will also publish related

Equality analysis should be reviewed after a sensible period of time to see if business needs have changed and/or if the effects that were expected have occurred. If not then you will need to consider amending your policy accordingly. This does not mean repeating the equality analysis, but using the experience gained through implementation to check the findings and to make any necessary adjustments.

Engagement with the community is recommended as part of the development of equality analysis. The council's Community Engagement Division and critical friend, the Forum for Equality and Human Rights in Southwark can assist with this (see section below on community engagement and [www.southwarkadvice.org.uk](http://www.southwarkadvice.org.uk)).

Whilst the equality analysis is being considered, Southwark Council recommends considering implications arising from socio-economic disadvantage, as socio-economic inequalities have a strong influence on the environment we live and work in. As a major provider of services to Southwark residents, the council has a policy commitment to reduce socio-economic inequalities and this is reflected in its values and aims. For this reason, the council recommends considering impacts/needs arising from socio-economic disadvantage in all equality analyses, not forgetting to include identified potential mitigating actions. **The Council has adopted the Socio-Economic Duty as part of its overall equality, diversity and inclusion policy commitments in the Southwark Equality Framework.** This requires us to ensure we do not make any conditions worse for those experiencing socio-economic disadvantage through our policies and practices.

**Section 1: Equality impact and needs analysis details**

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| Proposed policy/decision/business plan to which this equality analysis relates |            |          | A Social Purpose of Land Framework |          |                    |
| Equality analysis author                                                       |            |          | Lauren Mudd                        |          |                    |
| Strategic Director:                                                            |            |          | Clive Palfreyman                   |          |                    |
| Department                                                                     |            |          | Planning and Growth                | Division | Sustainable Growth |
| Period analysis undertaken                                                     |            |          | August 2025 – November 2025        |          |                    |
| Date of review (if applicable)                                                 |            |          | N/A                                |          |                    |
| Sign-off                                                                       | Neil Kirby | Position | Head of Sustainable Growth         | Date     | 1 December 2025    |

**Section 2:** Brief description of policy/decision/business plan

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| 1.1 Brief description of policy/decision/business plan                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
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| <p>The Social Purpose of Land Framework (the “Framework”) is Southwark Council’s proposed tool for engaging the community on how public land could be used. It prioritises social outcomes, equity, and community voice, aiming to make land use decisions more transparent, participatory, and accountable. The Social Purpose of Land Framework introduces structured processes like the Neighbourhood Land Panels to ensure that residents and community organisations have meaningful influence over how council-owned land is used.</p> <p>The Framework does not replace existing functions of the planning legislation. The application of the Framework is intended to occur prior to the formal application process for obtaining planning permission.</p> <p>The Framework is a multi-functional tool that:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Provides a process on how the community can be involved in evaluating land use options based on social purpose.</li><li>• Establishes a governance model that embeds community participation at every stage.</li><li>• Acts as a public accountability mechanism, ensuring transparency and traceability in decisions.</li><li>• Functions as an equity and repair tool, addressing historical imbalances in land governance.</li></ul> <p>The Framework will first be tested on pilot council-owned sites.</p> |

**Section 3:** Overview of service users and key stakeholders consulted

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| 2. Service users and stakeholders                                        |                                                                                                                                                  |
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| Key users of the department or service                                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Southwark Council staff</li><li>• Southwark Council partners</li><li>• Southwark residents</li></ul>     |
| Key stakeholders were/are involved in this policy/decision/business plan | Clive Palfreyman – Strategic Director for Resources<br>Steve Platts – Director of Planning and Growth<br>Neil Kirby – Head of Sustainable Growth |

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**Section 4: Pre-implementation equality impact and needs analysis**

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This section considers the potential impacts (positive and negative) on groups with ‘protected characteristics’, the equality information on which this analysis is based and any mitigating actions to be taken, including improvement actions to promote equality and tackle inequalities. An equality analysis also presents as an opportunity to improve services to meet diverse needs, promote equality, tackle inequalities and promote good community relations. It is not just about addressing negative impacts.

The columns include societal issues (discrimination, exclusion, needs etc.) and socio-economic issues (levels of poverty, employment, income). As the two aspects are heavily interrelated it may not be practical to fill out both columns on all protected characteristics. The aim is, however, to ensure that socio-economic issues are given special consideration, as it is the council’s intention to reduce socio-economic inequalities in the borough. Key is also the link between protected characteristics and socio-economic disadvantage, including experiences of multiple disadvantage.

**Socio-economic disadvantage may arise from a range of factors, including:**

- poverty
- health
- education
- limited social mobility
- housing
- a lack of expectations
- discrimination
- multiple disadvantage

**The public sector equality duty (PSED)** requires us to find out about and give due consideration to the needs of different protected characteristics in relation to the three parts of the duty:

1. Eliminating discrimination, harassment and victimisation
2. Advancing equality of opportunity, including finding out about and meeting diverse needs of our local communities, addressing disadvantage and barriers to equal access; enabling all voices to be heard in our engagement and consultation undertaken; increasing the participation of underrepresented groups
3. Fostering good community relations; promoting good relations; to be a borough where all feel welcome, included, valued, safe and respected.

The PSED is now also further reinforced in the two additional Fairer Future For All values: that we will

- Always work to make Southwark more equal and just
- Stand against all forms of discrimination and racism

**Age** - Where this is referred to, it refers to a person belonging to a particular age (e.g. 32 year olds) or range of ages (e.g. 18 - 30 year olds).

**Potential impacts (positive and negative) of proposed policy/decision/business plan; this also includes needs in relation to each part of the duty.**

**Potential Socio-Economic impacts/ needs/issues arising from socio-economic disadvantage (positive and negative)**

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| <p><u><i>Potential positive impacts</i></u></p> <p>The application of the Framework will support community-led decision making on proposed development. The Neighbourhood Missions that are developed have an opportunity to prioritise youth inclusion and accessibility for older residents.</p> <p>Those participating in the Framework can also influence how the pilot sites are developed for example, supporting repurposing a site for a youth centre, play areas, or educational hub.</p> <p>The Neighbourhood Land Panels will reserve a seat for a young person, ensuring youth perspectives are heard.</p> <p>There is no negative impact associated with the Social Purpose of Land.</p> | <p><u><i>Potential positive impacts</i></u></p> <p>The Framework prioritises community-led proposals, giving disadvantaged young or older people more influence over land use decisions.</p> <p>By making land governance more open, the Framework helps demystify decision-making and reduce the exclusion of young or older people.</p> <p>There is no negative impact associated with the Social Purpose of Land.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <p><b>Equality information on which above analysis is based</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <p><b>Socio-Economic data on which above analysis is based</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <p><u><i>General data</i></u></p> <p>The average (median) age of Southwark is 33 years, lower than the median age in London as a whole (35).<br/>(Source: <a href="#">How life has changed in Southwark: Census 2021 (ons.gov.uk)</a>).</p> <p>In 2021, 3.3 million people aged 65 years and over were living alone in England and Wales.<br/>(Source: <a href="#">Profile of the older population living in England and Wales in 2021 and changes since 2011 (ons.gov.uk)</a>).</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <p><u><i>General data</i></u></p> <p>Economic inactivity in Southwark is slightly higher than across London. Across London, 21.4% of people aged 16 to 64 years were economically inactive during the year ending December 2023. Around 51,900 people or 21.6% of the population aged 16 to 64 years in Southwark were "economically inactive" in the year ending December 2023.<br/><a href="#">Southwark's employment, unemployment and economic inactivity - ONS</a></p> <p>As of the year ending December 2023, Southwark had an employment rate of 76.5% among residents aged 16 to 64, higher than the London average<br/><a href="#">Southwark's employment, unemployment and economic inactivity - ONS</a>.</p> |
| <p><b>Mitigating and/or improvement actions to be taken</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

The application of the Framework will ensure different age group representation is made across each of the Neighbourhood Land Panels. Southwark Council continues to support and works with underrepresented organisations and groups wherever possible, and support and engage with underrepresented groups in a number of ways including business support and access to grant funding.

Targeted outreach to underrepresented groups (e.g., LGBTQ+ youth, disabled residents, older people, faith-based communities) will be resourced and embedded in the Neighbourhood Missions and Panel recruitment stages.

Flexible formats for the Panel meetings and ongoing involvement should be considered to reduce barriers for different groups.

Training for Panel members on unconscious bias and inclusive decision-making will be considered to ensure fairer outcomes.

**Disability** - A person has a disability if s/he has a physical or mental impairment which has a substantial and long-term adverse effect on that person's ability to carry out normal day-to-day activities.

Please note that under the PSED due regard includes:

Giving due consideration in all relevant areas to “the steps involved in meeting the needs of disabled persons that are different from the needs of persons who are not disabled include, in particular, steps to take account of disabled persons' disabilities.” This also includes the need to understand and focus on different needs/impacts arising from different disabilities.

| Potential impacts (positive and negative) of proposed policy/decision/business plan; this also includes needs in relation to each part of the duty.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Potential socio-economic impacts/needs/issues arising from socio-economic disadvantage (positive and negative)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
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| <p><u>Potential positive impacts</u></p> <p>The Framework encourages land uses that reflects local social needs, which may include accessible community spaces, inclusive housing, and mobility-friendly infrastructure.</p> <p>The participatory model, especially through Neighbourhood Land Panels, creates opportunities for disabled residents and disability advocacy groups to shape land use decisions.</p> <p>The Framework values lived experience as a form of expertise, helping ensure disabled people's perspectives are taken seriously.</p> <p>There is no negative impact associated with the Framework for Southwark Council.</p> | <p><u>Potential positive impacts</u></p> <p>Participation in Neighbourhood Land Panels and community consultations can help surface intersectional needs, such as those faced by disabled people who also experience poverty, isolation, or housing insecurity.</p> <p>Disabled people facing socio-economic disadvantage may encounter multiple barriers to engaging in the Framework's processes—such as lack of digital access, transport, time, or support.</p> <p>There is no negative impact</p> |

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|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | associated with the Framework for Southwark Council.                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Equality information on which above analysis is based</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <b>Socio-economic data on which above analysis is based</b>                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <u><b>General data</b></u><br>3 out of 4 disabled people (72%) have experienced negative attitudes or behaviour in the last 5 years.<br><br>9 out of 10 disabled people (87%) who had experienced negative attitudes or behaviour said it had a negative effect on their daily lives. (Source: Disability facts and figures (Scope.org.uk)).<br><br>14% of Southwark residents reported being disabled on the 2021 Census, in line with London and England averages. The number of disabled residents increased by 3,000 (8%) between 2011 and 2021 (Source: 2011 and 2021 Census). | <u><b>General data</b></u><br><br>There is a strong association between disability and poverty in Southwark, with disabled people more likely to experience income deprivation, housing insecurity, and barriers to employment. |
| <b>Mitigating and/or improvement actions to be taken</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| The application of the Framework will involve tailored outreach and accessibility measures, so these groups are not excluded from participation in the pilot process.<br><br>See above response.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

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| <b>Gender reassignment:</b><br>- The process of transitioning from one gender to another.<br><b>Gender Identity:</b> Gender identity is the personal sense of one's own gender. Gender identity can correlate with a person's assigned sex or can differ from it.                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Potential impacts (positive and negative) of proposed policy/decision/business plan; this also includes needs in relation to each part of the duty.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>Potential socio-economic impacts/needs/issues arising from socio-economic disadvantage (positive and negative)</b> |
| <u><b>Potential positive impacts</b></u><br><br>The participatory model, especially through Neighbourhood Land Panels, encourages participation from all members of the community, regardless of gender.<br><br>The Framework encourages proposals that respond to local unmet needs, such as youth mental health, safety, and inclusive community spaces. This opens the door for gender-affirming projects like: |                                                                                                                       |

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• LGBTQ+ youth centres</li> <li>• Gender-inclusive housing or shelters</li> <li>• Safe spaces for trans and non-binary individuals</li> </ul> <p>The Framework aligns with Southwark 2030 goals of reducing inequality and empowering people, which can be interpreted to include gender identity as a core axis of social justice.</p> <p>There is no negative impact associated with the Framework for Southwark Council.</p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Equality information on which above analysis is based.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <b>Socio-economic data on which above analysis is based</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <p><u>General data</u></p> <p>In Southwark, about 1 in 80 (1.2%, 3,200) residents reported a gender identity different from their birth sex registration, significantly higher than London (0.9%) and England (0.5%) levels. These are probably substantial under-estimates: 7.3% of Southwark residents did not answer (2021 Census).</p>                                                                                                                             | <p><u>General data</u></p> <p>Existing research shows that transgender Londoners are a marginalised group who faces multiple barriers regarding healthcare, education, housing, and employment (Source: Census 2021 deep dive: gender identity and deprivation in London (<a href="https://trustforlondon.org.uk">trustforlondon.org.uk</a>))</p> |
| <b>Mitigating and/or improvement actions to be taken</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| See above responses.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

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| <p><b>Marriage and civil partnership</b> – In England and Wales marriage is no longer restricted to a union between a man and a woman but now includes a marriage between a same-sex couples. Same-sex couples can also have their relationships legally recognised as 'civil partnerships'. Civil partners must not be treated less favourably than married couples and must be treated the same as married couples on a wide range of legal matters. <b>(Only to be considered in respect to the need to eliminate discrimination.)</b></p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Potential impacts (positive and negative) of proposed policy/decision/business plan</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>Potential socio-economic impacts/ needs/issues arising from socio-economic disadvantage (positive and negative)</b>                                                                                                                   |
| <p><u>Potential positive impacts</u></p> <p>The Framework's emphasis on equity and care supports diverse relationship types and household arrangements, including those not traditionally recognised in planning or service delivery.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <p><u>Potential positive impacts</u></p> <p>Civil partnerships and non-traditional family structures may benefit from inclusive design and programming, especially where mainstream services have been inaccessible or unaffordable.</p> |

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| <p>The equity principles within the Framework challenges traditional, often heteronormative, assumptions about who public land is for and how it should be used.</p> <p>There is no negative impact associated with the Framework for Southwark Council.</p>                                                                                                                                                  | <p>There is no negative impact associated with the Framework for Southwark Council.</p> |
| <p><b>Equality information on which above analysis is based</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <p><b>Socio-economic data on which above analysis is based</b></p>                      |
| <p><u><b>General data</b></u></p> <p>Those identifying as heterosexual or straight were most likely to be married (46.4%) in 2022, while for those identifying as LGB, the majority had never married or entered a civil partnership (72.0% of those identifying as lesbian or gay and 82.9% of those identifying as bisexual, respectively. (Source: Sexual orientation, UK: 2021 and 2022 (ons.gov.uk))</p> |                                                                                         |
| <p><b>Mitigating or improvement actions to be taken</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                         |
| <p>See above responses.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                         |

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| <p><b>Pregnancy and maternity</b> - Pregnancy is the condition of being pregnant or expecting a baby. Maternity refers to the period after the birth, and is linked to maternity leave in the employment context. In the non-work context, protection against maternity discrimination is for 26 weeks after giving birth, and this includes treating a woman unfavourably because she is breastfeeding.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                              |
| <p><b>Potential impacts (positive and negative) of proposed policy/decision/business plan; this also includes needs in relation to each part of the duty.</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <p><b>Potential socio-economic impacts/needs/issues arising from socio-economic disadvantage (positive and negative)</b></p> |
| <p><u><b>Potential positive impacts</b></u></p> <p>The framework encourages the repurposing of underused council-owned sites for community benefit, which could include:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Family-friendly community hubs</li> <li>• Accessible childcare facilities</li> <li>• Parenting support centres</li> <li>• Safe, inclusive spaces for prenatal and postnatal care</li> </ul> <p>Through the Framework, communities could identify unmet needs such as maternal health, childcare, or family support which could guide land use decisions.</p> <p>There is limited data available for this characteristic in relation to the Social Purpose of Land Framework, but no detrimental impacts are expected from the</p> |                                                                                                                              |

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| <p>Framework.</p> <p>There is no negative impact associated with the Framework for Southwark Council.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                    |
| <p><b>Equality information on which above analysis is based</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <p><b>Socio-economic data on which above analysis is based</b></p> |
| <p><u>General data</u></p> <p>Overall, three in four mothers have said they have experienced a negative or possibly discriminatory experience during pregnancy, maternity leave, and/or on return from maternity leave.<br/>(Source: <a href="#">Pregnancy and Maternity-related Discrimination and Disadvantage (EHRC)</a>)</p> |                                                                    |
| <p><b>Mitigating and/or improvement actions to be taken</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                    |
| <p>See above responses.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                    |

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| <p><b>Race</b> - Refers to the protected characteristic of Race. It refers to a group of people defined by their race, colour, and nationality (including citizenship) ethnic or national origins. N.B. Gypsy, Roma and Traveller are recognised racial groups, and their needs should be considered alongside all others</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <p><b>Potential impacts (positive and negative) of proposed policy/decision/business plan; this also includes needs in relation to each part of the duty.</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <p><b>Potential socio-economic impacts/ needs/issues arising from socio-economic disadvantage (positive and negative)</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <p><u>Potential positive impacts</u></p> <p>The Framework aims to shift power from traditional council-led decision-making to community-led governance, prioritising racially minoritised groups historically excluded from land use decisions.</p> <p>The framework creates structured opportunities for racially minoritised residents and organisations to propose, shape, and evaluate land use projects.</p> <p>It also values lived experience and cultural insight as forms of expertise, helping to reflect the needs of people within the community from marginalised groups.</p> <p>Offers a pathway for rebuilding relationships</p> | <p><u>Potential positive impacts</u></p> <p>Supports local enterprise and employment by enabling community-led projects that generate income, jobs, and training opportunities – particularly those led by ethnic minority groups.</p> <p>Prioritises low-yielding or surplus assets, which can be repurposed for economic activities benefiting racially minoritised entrepreneurs and organisations.</p> <p>Reduces barriers to entry by offering more accessible engagement opportunities and</p> |

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| <p>through transparency, shared governance, and enforceable commitments.</p> <p>There is no negative impact associated with the Framework for Southwark Council.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <p>council support during the process.</p> <p>There is no negative impact associated with the Framework for Southwark Council.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Equality information on which above analysis is based</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <b>Socio-economic data on which above analysis is based</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <p><u>General data</u></p> <p>In 2021, 9.9% of Southwark residents identified their ethnic group as Asian, Asian British or Asian Welsh, 25.1% as Black, Black British, Black Welsh, Caribbean or African, 7.2% as Mixed or Multiple ethnic groups and 6.3% of as 'Other' category ('Arab' or 'Any other ethnic group') (Source: ONS, Census 2021).</p> <p>There are many factors contributing to the changing ethnic composition of England and Wales, such as differing patterns of ageing, fertility, mortality, and migration. Changes may also be caused by differences in the way individuals choose to self-identify between censuses.<br/>(Source: <a href="https://www.ons.gov.uk/peoplepopulationandcommunity/ethnicityandnationality/articles/howlifehaschangedinsouthwark/census2021/2021-03-29">How life has changed in Southwark: Census 2021 (ons.gov.uk)</a>)</p> | <p><u>General data</u></p> <p>Between March 2020 and January 2021, we know that Black, Asian and minority ethnic communities, young people and people in low-income households experienced job, financial and household insecurity which led to increasing financial stress and negative impacts on mental health (Source: <a href="https://www.southwark.gov.uk/standstogether/annual-report-2021">Southwark Stands Together Annual Report 2021 (Southwark.gov.uk)</a>)</p> |
| <b>Mitigating and/or improvement actions to be taken</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| See above responses.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

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| <p><b>Religion and belief</b> - Religion has the meaning usually given to it but belief includes religious and philosophical beliefs including lack of belief (e.g. Atheism). Generally, a belief should affect your life choices or the way you live for it to be included in the definition.</p> |                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Potential impacts (positive and negative) of proposed policy/decision/business plan; this also includes needs in relation to each part of the duty.</b>                                                                                                                                         | <b>Potential socio-economic impacts/needs/issues arising from socio-economic disadvantage (positive and negative)</b> |
| <p><u>Potential positive impacts</u></p> <p>The framework could enable the establishment of the following uses on council-</p>                                                                                                                                                                     | <p><u>Potential positive impacts</u></p> <p>Access to land through the Framework can help these</p>                   |

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| <p>owned land where, meeting a local or strategic need:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Places of worship</li> <li>• Interfaith community centres</li> <li>• Faith-based social services (e.g. food banks, youth centres).</li> </ul> <p>Faith communities, especially those from minoritised backgrounds, could gain formal roles in governance through Neighbourhood Land Panels and the potential Stewardship Board. This helps raise awareness of those that may be underrepresented in planning and regeneration processes.</p> <p>There is no negative impact associated with the Framework for Southwark Council.</p>           | <p>groups scale their impact, improving wellbeing and social cohesion.</p> <p>The framework supports community-led stewardship, which can help protect and promote religious heritage, traditions, and practices.</p> <p>There is no negative impact associated with the Framework for Southwark Council.</p> |
| <b>Equality information on which above analysis is based</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <b>Socio-economic data on which above analysis is based</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <p><u><b>General data</b></u></p> <p>In 2021/22, Home Office's Annual Hate Crime Statistics show there were 8,730 religious or other faith-based Hate Crimes, an increase of 37% from last year. (Source: <a href="https://stophateuk.org/">Religious Discrimination (stophateuk.org)</a>)</p> <p>Over 40 distinct religions were identified among Southwark residents according to 2021 Census. Around 133,300 Southwark residents reported their religion as Christian: over two fifths (43%) of the population and 29,600 Southwark residents reported their religion as Muslim, making up one tenth (10%) of the population (Census, 2021).</p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Mitigating and/or improvement actions to be taken</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| See above responses.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

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| <b>Sex</b> - A man or a woman.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Potential impacts (positive and negative) of proposed policy/decision/business plan; this also includes needs in relation to each part of the duty.</b>                                                                                                                                        | <b>Potential socio-economic impacts/ needs/issues arising from socio-economic disadvantage (positive and negative)</b> |
| <p><u><b>Potential positive impacts</b></u></p> <p>The Social Purpose of Land Framework could assist in prioritising spaces or uses that address gender-specific needs (i.e. childcare, men's mental health).</p> <p>The establishment and application of Neighbourhood Land Panels and their</p> |                                                                                                                        |

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| <p>missions could assist in identifying and addressing unmet needs relating to gender-based disparities in accessing public spaces. Women and men may experience public space differently; embedding their lived experiences into land use decisions can lead to more inclusive urban design.</p> <p>The framework's emphasis on designing with the community and-defined missions allows for targeted responses to gendered issues such as women's health and wellbeing, men's mental health and social isolation, gender-based violence prevention and support for single parents.</p> |                                                             |
| <b>Equality information on which above analysis is based</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <b>Socio-economic data on which above analysis is based</b> |
| <p><u>General data</u></p> <p>Of the UK's small and medium-sized enterprises with employees, 18% were led by women in 2022, according to data from the Government's annual Small Business Survey.<br/>(Source: <a href="https://researchbriefings.files.parliament.uk">Women and the UK economy (researchbriefings.files.parliament.uk)</a>)</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                             |
| <b>Mitigating and/or improvement actions to be taken</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                             |
| See above responses.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                             |

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| <p><b>Sexual orientation</b> - Whether a person's sexual attraction is towards their own sex, the opposite sex or to both sexes</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Potential impacts (positive and negative) of proposed policy/decision/business plan; this also includes needs in relation to each part of the duty.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>Potential socio-economic impacts/ needs/issues arising from socio-economic disadvantage (positive and negative)</b> |
| <p><u>Potential positive impacts</u></p> <p>The Framework aims to include historically excluded groups in land use decisions. The themes around democratic participation and power-shifting can also benefit LGBTQ+ individuals, including those marginalised due to sexual orientation.</p> <p>The Framework also supports community involvement in the development process which could lead to the establishment of safer spaces for LGBTQ+ youth, community centres, or health and wellbeing hubs tailored to LGBTQ+ needs.</p> <p>The Framework values lived experience alongside technical expertise. LGBTQ+ individuals and organisations bring unique insights into spatial justice, safety, and inclusion, which can shape land use decisions.</p> |                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Equality information on which above analysis is based</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>Socio-economic data on which above analysis is based</b>                                                            |

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| <u><b>General data</b></u>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |
| <p>In 2021, 8.1% of residents aged 16+ identified as non-heterosexual. Specifically, 4.5% of Southwark's residents identified as lesbian or gay, and 3.2% identified as bisexual or pansexual. The borough ranked as the 4th highest in England for LGB+ identity, and it also ranked 5th for the proportion of residents with a trans or non-binary gender identity, with 1.2% of residents identifying as such.</p> |  |
| <b>Mitigating and/or improvement actions to be taken</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |
| <p>See above responses.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |

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| <b>Human Rights</b> <p>There are 16 rights in the Human Rights Act. Each one is called an Article. They are all taken from the European Convention on Human Rights. The Articles are The right to life, Freedom from torture, inhuman and degrading treatment, Freedom from forced labour , Right to Liberty, Fair trial, Retrospective penalties, Privacy, Freedom of conscience, Freedom of expression, Freedom of assembly, Marriage and family, Freedom from discrimination and the First Protocol</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Potential impacts (positive and negative) of proposed policy/decision/business plan</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <p>The Social Purpose of Land Framework for Southwark Council support several Human Rights Act articles, enhancing human rights for communities within the borough.</p> <p><b>Article 8 – Right to Respect for Private and Family Life</b><br/> The Framework provides for community involvement in land use decision making in order to reflect local needs (e.g., housing, care spaces, youth centres). The Framework also supports environments where people can live with dignity, privacy, and family cohesion. Increasing the opportunity for community involvement in this process creates more equitable access opportunities to land use decision making, and helps protect the right to life, especially for vulnerable groups such as those with health inequalities.</p> <p><b>Article 10 – Freedom of Expression</b><br/> The Framework encourages public participation, deliberation, and community voice in land governance. This gives residents, including marginalised groups, gain platforms to express needs and shape their environments, fostering civic engagement and empowerment.</p> <p><b>Article 9 – Freedom of Thought, Conscience and Religion</b><br/> Involving the community in developing land use proposals could involve the development of faith-based uses of land (e.g., places of worship, interfaith</p> |

centres), supporting religious expression. This strengthens social cohesion and provides inclusive spaces for spiritual and cultural practices.

#### **Article 14 – Protection from Discrimination**

The Framework emphasises equity and power-shifting principles which aim to redress inequalities, including those based on race, sex, sexual orientation, disability, and other protected characteristics. This creates fairer access to public resources, improved representation, and targeted support for all.

#### **Article 11 – Freedom of Assembly and Association**

The framework enables community organisations to be a part of land use decision making to meet together and deliberate future use of space. This supports grassroots activities and fosters democratic participation.

#### **Protocol 1, Article 1 – Protection of Property**

While this right primarily protects private property, the Framework ensures that public land is used transparently and fairly. This allows communities further involvement in how the pilot sites (especially for long-term stewardship or meanwhile use) is used.

#### **Article 2 – Right to Life (Indirectly)**

While this right is not directly about land, the Framework can support uses that are in direct response to local or strategic need that improve public health and safety (e.g., mental health hubs, food access, safe youth spaces). This can reduce harm and promote wellbeing.

There is no negative impact associated with the Social Purpose of Land Framework for Southwark Council.

#### **Information on which above analysis is based**

[The Human Rights Act](https://equalityhumanrights.com) (equalityhumanrights.com)

#### **Mitigating and/or improvement actions to be taken**

As there are no negative impacts, no mitigating actions are required. The Council will continue to monitor impacts on human rights. The Council will mitigate against any unforeseen issues that arise.

## **Conclusions**

**Summarise main findings and conclusions of the overall equality impact and needs analysis for this area:**

The Social Purpose of Land Framework for Southwark provides an important opportunity to make a positive impact on those in the community who may experience discrimination, inequality, and exclusion due to one or more protected characteristics. By adopting the processes within the Framework, Southwark Council is presenting a public commitment to supporting underrepresented groups as part of the decision-making process in the use of public land.

This framework will ensure that the community has a stronger voice when decisions are made on how council land is used in the future, contributing to reducing systemic inequality and fostering a fairer, more inclusive community for all.

To ensure that the proposed process is undertaken and remains relevant for stakeholders involved, the council will ensure regular engagement is made with the community through the Neighbourhood Land Panels, as well as the neighbourhood engagement opportunities once the Cabinet approves the framework’s application on the pilot phase.

**Section 5: Further equality actions and objectives**

| 5. Further actions                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                 |
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| Based on the initial analysis above, please detail the key mitigating and/or improvement actions to promote equality and tackle inequalities; and any areas identified as requiring more detailed analysis. |                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                 |
| Number                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Description of issue                                                                  | Action                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Timeframe                                       |
| 1                                                                                                                                                                                                           | The need for different age group representation across the Neighbourhood Land Panels. | As part of the recruitment of the Neighbourhood Land Panels, there will be a reserve spot for youth representation on each panel. Engagement as part of the panels’ recruitment will also involve more inclusive approach and channels for communication to ensure all ages are involved | Upon commencement of the framework and ongoing. |
| 2                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Understanding local needs of underrepresented or                                      | Targeted outreach and engagement to reach                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Upon commencement of the framework and          |

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|   | vulnerable groups.                                                                                                                                                                                    | underrepresented groups (e.g., LGBTQ+ youth, disabled residents, older people, faith-based communities) will be resourced and embedded in the Neighbourhood Mission and Panel recruitment stages. | ongoing.                                        |
| 3 | Accessibility in participating in the Neighbourhood Land Panels.                                                                                                                                      | Flexible formats for the panels meetings and ongoing involvement should be considered to reduce barriers for different groups.                                                                    | Upon commencement of the framework and ongoing. |
| 4 | Expertise and experience of the Neighbourhood Land Panels' membership where involving members that are historically marginalised from accessing resources that would enable meaningful participation. | Training for panel members on unconscious bias and inclusive decision-making will be considered to ensure fairer outcomes.                                                                        | Upon commencement of the framework and ongoing. |